Portfolio case study by Rupak Ghanpathi · built solo · sample data

A distributor pays short. On day 31 it's still nobody's problem.

Every Rupee is a short-payment reconciliation desk for FMCG finance teams, built from Cello World's public filings. Every gap gets one owner and ends in a credit note or a recovery.

Try the live desk › Talk to Rupak

The hard part of a deduction isn't matching it. It's owning it.

> **The call I made:** control over speed. No auto write-offs, maker-checker above ₹10,000, strict matching at launch. Fewer auto-matches and more manual work, on purpose.

Today's short-payments

Click a gap: what, why, who, how it ends.

Sample data · 4 gaps · ₹17,590

₹1,180	Scheme claim Festival discount, budget approved	Closed
₹12,400	Scheme claim No approved budget: a verbal promise	1 day left
₹3,150	Damage claim Proof of delivery attached	Needs checker
₹860	TDS Tax withheld under section 194Q	Matched

₹1,180 · Scheme claim

Festival discount, budget approved

WHAT	Paid ₹10,620 on ₹11,800; took a 10% festival discount.
WHY	Budget approved, evidence attached: valid (BR-3).
WHO	Asha, finance ops. Under ₹10,000, no checker.
HOW	GST credit note ₹1,180 (₹1,000 + ₹180 GST). Distributor reverses; brand recovers ₹180.

Step 1 of 5 · **Payment arrives.** ₹10,620 on a ₹11,800 bill.

Next step › | Replay | Do it in the product

BEFORE AND AFTER

The same ₹12,400 gap, two ways

	HOW IT OFTEN RUNS TODAY	ON THE DESK
Explained	Day 31, if ever	Same day, by rule
Where it lives	Email threads, no owner	One case, one owner, one deadline
Who decides	Whoever replies first	Regional sales head, 3-day SLA (BR-8)
How it ends	Silent write-off, or never	Credit note or recovery, with a posting reference
Audit trail	Rebuilt from inboxes	Every action logged by name and time

Illustrative: one gap from the sample data, traced through the workflow. "Today" is the common manual pattern, not a measured baseline.

0 auto write-offs · maker-checker above ₹10,000 · 8 rules, 11 tests, run in the browser

TRACEABILITY

From a public filing to a running control

FILING

Receivables +14.0% vs revenue +8.8%

Cello World, FY25→FY26

ASSUMPTION

Short-payments sit unowned

A reason to look, not a diagnosis

REQUIREMENT

US-5: no self-approval above ₹10,000

In the BRD

RULE

BR-5 maker-checker

Blocked, logged, routed

TEST

UAT-06 passes

Maker tries to approve own case

SCREEN

Vikram approves

Finance controller, in the desk

WHAT IT'S WORTH

See what short-payments cost you

Monthly billing to distributors (₹ lakh)	500
Share short-paid (%)	3
Days to settle	60
Cost of money (% a year)	12

₹30 lakh

cash stuck at any time

₹3.6 lakh

yearly interest cost

Billing × share × days÷30 = cash stuck. Try your own numbers.

THE QUESTION I'D ASK YOU

Which deduction type creates the most tickets or manual work for your customers today?

Answer it in one line

THE PART NOBODY OWNS

A deduction can have a tax deadline.

When a brand settles a scheme claim with a **GST credit note**, it gets back the GST already paid on the discount. That credit note must go out by **30 November after the financial year ends** (or the annual return date, if earlier). For FY 2025-26 supplies, that's **30 November 2026**.

Many brands settle schemes with a plain **financial credit note** instead and keep the GST cost. From 1 Nov 2026 the GST route gets easier, so more claims will qualify. An undecided deduction quietly loses that choice after the deadline.

The brand's GST gain is the distributor's input-credit reversal. That's why the two sides negotiate which kind of credit note gets issued.

CGST Act s.34(2); s.15(3)(b) as amended by Finance Act 2026; CBIC Circular 251/08/2025. Summarised from public sources, Oct 2026. Not tax advice.

25

days to the FY 2025-26 credit-note deadline

WHY NOW

Why this matters now

+14% vs +8.8%

Cello's receivables outgrew revenue

About ₹34 Cr above revenue pace, FY25→FY26.

Annual reports · my estimate, a reason to look, not a diagnosis

₹3.5–5

Distributor margin per ₹100

Too thin to wait on slow claims, so they deduct.

AICPDF, Jun 2026

1 Nov 2026

New GST credit-note rule

Untracked credit note, unrecovered GST.

Finance Act 2026 · CBIC 03/2026

THE THINKING

Controls first, failure planned for

What this costs

- Fewer auto-matches at launch: strict matching rejects fuzzy ones.
- More manual review: anything above ₹10,000 needs a second person.
- A slower first close: Sales must enter scheme dates and budgets before rules can accept a claim.

What I got wrong: v2 was a wall of text, so I rebuilt it as something you can run, because a spec nobody executes isn't a spec.

How I'd work from week one

1. **Evidence first.** Every fact dated and sourced.
2. **One owner per gap.** One decision, one deadline.
3. **Testable rules.** 8 rules, 11 tests, "must block" cases included.
4. **Controls built in.** Maker-checker, no auto write-offs. Zero SOX findings at HDFC.

Where it could fail, and the fix

1. **Distributors pay the old account.** Keep it open a quarter; Sales gets a weekly list.
2. **Schemes change mid-quarter.** No dates and budget from Sales, no valid scheme.
3. **Sales overrides the credit flag.** It never blocks an order; overrides are logged by name.

Runs in your browser. Uploaded files never leave your device. **No sign-up, no tracking.**

Sample data only. Sources, and what I don't claim ›

See it work on today's short-payments.

Sample data, no sign-up. Takes two minutes.

Try the live desk ›

Talk to Rupak



I'm Rupak. I spent 2.5 years as a Business Analyst at HDFC Bank: 25+ BRDs, 15+ releases on time, zero SOX findings. I built Every Rupee alone: from Cello's annual report to the rules, product and tests.

— Rupak

Building for finance ops or fintech?

One tap, email pre-filled.

Let's talk this week

Not a fit, here's why

Or ask one question. I reply within a day.

Ask

Open to BA and Product roles · fintech, BFSI, finance software · Bengaluru · immediate joiner

Every Rupee

Every short-paid rupee gets a reason,
an owner and an ending.

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THE WORK

- Open the product
- Forward to a colleague
- Run the 11 tests
- Full case study
- BRD (PDF)
- One-pager (PDF)

TRUST

- Sources
- Privacy
- GitHub

MORE BY RUPAK

Portfolio

Viraam

Ten Today

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Tax rules summarised from public sources, Oct 2026. Not tax advice.